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Inventor(s)

HYUN; Ju Ho

LIGHT LEAKAGE PREVENTION APPARATUS FOR VEHICLE AND MANUFACTURING METHOD THEREOF

Abstract

A light leakage prevention apparatus for a vehicle, and a method therefor are provided. The apparatus includes a printed circuit board (PCB) including two or more light sources, a light leakage prevention member that shields interference between the two or more light sources, a housing including a receiving space for receiving the light leakage prevention member, and a cover coupled to an upper end of the housing. The light leakage prevention member is a product composed of two types of colors or two types of molding materials in one mold, and the product is a heterogeneous material.

Inventors: HYUN; Ju Ho (Daegu, KR)

Applicant: HYUNDAI MOBIS CO., LTD. (Seoul, KR)

Family ID: 1000008673457

Assignee: HYUNDAI MOBIS CO., LTD. (Seoul, KR)

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION

[0001] This application claims the benefit under 35 USC § 119 (a) of Korean Patent Application No. 10-2024-0190028, filed on Dec. 18, 2024, in the Korean Intellectual Property Office, the entire disclosure(s) of which is hereby incorporated herein by reference in its entirety for all purposes.

BACKGROUND

1. Field

[0002] The present disclosure relates to a light leakage prevention apparatus for a vehicle and a manufacturing method thereof.

2. Description of the Related Art

[0003] The description described in this part merely provides background information for the present disclosure, and does not constitute the conventional art.

[0004] The infotainment of a vehicle not only provides an entertainment function to a user, but also convenience in driving of the vehicle.

[0005] The infotainment of a vehicle includes a multimedia apparatus. For example, the multimedia apparatus may be configured in the form of a button used when playing an audio and a video. In order to ensure visibility during the day and night, the vehicle's infotainment irradiates light using a light source.

[0006] The infotainment of a vehicle according to the conventional art prevents light leakage of a light source by applying paint for preventing light leakage. However, the paint for preventing light leakage requires a spraying process, and there is a problem in that the manufacturing cost increases due to additional components needed therefor. In addition, in the spraying process, when the size of a masked component is small, a jig or the like cannot be applied. In addition, there is a problem that the paint for preventing light leakage invades a masking region, thereby lowering the quality and the yield.

SUMMARY

[0007] A light leakage prevention apparatus for a vehicle according to an embodiment may reduce manufacturing cost by not using paint for preventing light leakage.

[0008] A light leakage prevention apparatus for a vehicle according to an embodiment may improve yield and quality by injecting light leakage prevention members of different materials using a double injection molding.

[0009] A light leakage prevention apparatus for a vehicle according to an embodiment may maintain brightness of a light source by using a microspace formed between a shielding member and a transmission member having different polarities.

[0010] The problems to be solved by the present disclosure are not limited to the above-mentioned problems, and other problems that are not mentioned will be clearly understood by those skilled in the art from the following description.

[0011] In a general aspect of the disclosure, a light leakage prevention apparatus for a vehicle, includes: a printed circuit board (PCB) comprising two or more light sources; a light leakage prevention member that shields interference between the two or more light sources; a housing including a space for accommodating the light leakage prevention member; and a cover coupled to an upper end of the housing, wherein the light leakage prevention member comprises a transmission member and a shielding member alternately disposed in a direction of light transmission of the two or more light source, and wherein the transmission member and the shielding member are manufactured by a double injection molding such that the transmission member and the shielding member have different color or comprise different materials from each other.

[0012] The transmission member may be disposed in front of one of the two or more light sources and configured to transmit and emit light of the light source that is disposed at a rear of at least one of the two or more light sources, and the shielding member may be coupled to the transmission member and configured to shield light from the light source disposed behind the transmission member and a remainder of the two or more light sources.

[0013] The transmission member and the shielding member may have different polarities such that the transmission member and the shielding member form one or more microspaces on surfaces bonded to each other during the double injection molding.

[0014] The transmission member may reflect the light of the light source disposed at the rear of the at least one of the two or more light sources to a reflection surface formed from the one or more microspaces.

[0015] The transmission member may include a polar molecule selected from the group consisting of polycarbonate (PC), polymethyl methacrylate (PMMA), and polyamide (PA).

[0016] The shielding member may include a nonpolar molecule selected from the group consisting of polyethylene (PE), and polyamide (PP).

[0017] The light leakage prevention member may be heat treated after the double injection molding.

[0018] In another general aspect of the disclosure, a method for manufacturing a light leakage prevention apparatus for a vehicle, includes: double injection molding a product to form a light leakage prevention member comprising a transmission member and a shielding member alternately disposed in a direction of light transmission of two or more light source in a printed circuit board (PCB); heat-treating the light leakage prevention member; coupling the light leakage prevention member into a receiving space of a housing; and coupling a cover to an upper end of the housing, wherein the transmission member and the shielding member have different color or comprise different materials from each other by the double injection molding.

[0019] The heat-treating of the light leakage prevention member may include separating the transmission member and the shielding member from each other by a microspace.

[0020] The coupling of the light leakage prevention member into the receiving space of the housing may include disposing the light leakage prevention member in front of the at least one of two or more light sources to shield optical interference between different light sources.

[0021] The transmission member may include a polar molecule selected from the group consisting of polycarbonate (PC), polymethyl methacrylate (PMMA), and polyamide (PA).

[0022] The shielding member may include a nonpolar molecule selected from the group consisting of polyethylene (PE) and polyamide (PP).

[0023] According to an embodiment, since a light leakage prevention apparatus for a vehicle does not use paint for preventing light leakage, there is an effect of reducing the manufacturing cost.

[0024] According to an embodiment, a light leakage prevention apparatus for a vehicle has an effect of improving yield and quality by injecting light leakage prevention members of different materials using a double injection molding.

[0025] According to an embodiment, a light leakage prevention apparatus for a vehicle has an effect of maintaining brightness of a light source by using a microspace formed between a shielding member and a transmission member having different polarities.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0026] FIG. 1 is a diagram illustrating a configuration of a light leakage prevention apparatus for a vehicle according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0027] FIG. 2 is an exploded perspective view of a light leakage prevention apparatus for a vehicle

according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0028] FIG. 3 is a cross-sectional view taken along line A-A in FIG. 1.

[0029] FIG. 4 is a diagram briefly illustrating a configuration of a light leakage prevention apparatus for a vehicle according to another embodiment of the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0030] Hereinafter, some embodiments of the present disclosure will be described in detail with reference to exemplary drawings. Note that when components in each drawing are denoted by reference numerals, the same components are denoted by the same numerals as much as possible even if they are denoted on different drawings. In addition, in describing the present disclosure, if it is determined that a specific description of a related known configuration or function may obscure the subject matter of the present disclosure, the detailed description thereof will be omitted.

[0031] In describing components of embodiments of the present disclosure, reference numerals such as first, second, i), ii), a), and b) may be used. These symbols are only used to distinguish the components from other components, and the nature, sequence, order, or the like of the components is not limited by the symbols. In the specification, when a part “includes” or “comprises” a component, unless there is an explicit description to the contrary, the part may further include other components rather than excluding the other components.

[0032] In describing the components of the present invention, the terms first, second, A, B, (a), (b) and the like may be used. These terms are only used to distinguish the components from other components, and the nature, sequence, order, or the like of the components is not limited by these terms.

[0033] Where a component is described as being “connected,” “coupled” or “connected” to another component, it will be understood that the component may be directly connected or connected to the component, but that between each component another component may be “connected,” “coupled” or “connected.”

[0034] Terms such as “unit” and “module” described in the specification mean a unit that processes at least one function or operation, and may be implemented by hardware, software, or a combination of hardware and software.

[0035] Unless otherwise specified, it should be understood that the description of one embodiment may be applied to other embodiments.

[0036] The description set forth below in connection with the attached drawings is intended to describe exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure and is not intended to represent the only embodiments in which the present disclosure may be practiced.

[0037] FIG. 1 is a diagram illustrating a configuration of a light leakage prevention apparatus for a vehicle according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0038] FIG. 2 is an exploded perspective view of a light leakage prevention apparatus for a vehicle according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0039] Referring to FIGS. 1 and 2, a light leakage prevention apparatus for a vehicle **100** may be applied to a button inside the vehicle applied to an infotainment.

[0040] The light leakage prevention apparatus for a vehicle **100** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure includes a cover unit **110**, a light leakage prevention member **120**, a housing **130**, a rubber pad **140**, a printed circuit board (PCB) **150**, and some or all of a plurality of light sources **151** and **152**.

[0041] Light emitted from a first light source **151** among the plurality of light sources **151** and **152** is directly transmitted through the cover unit **110**. An image indicating an operation state of the button may be engraved or painted on an upper surface of the cover unit **110**.

[0042] The cover unit **110** is coupled to the housing **130** to be described later. The cover unit **110** may be snap-fit coupled to the housing **130**.

[0043] The light leakage prevention member **120** is coupled to any one of receiving spaces of the housing **130**. The light leakage prevention member **120** may shield optical interference between the

two light sources **151** and **152**.

[0044] The light leakage prevention member **120** may be manufactured based on a dual injection molding. Here, the double injection molding refers to a process of producing a product composed of two types of colors or two types of molding materials in one mold. The light leakage prevention member **120** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure may be manufactured by using molding materials having different polarities.

[0045] The light leakage prevention member **120** includes a shielding member **121** and a transmission member **122**.

[0046] The shapes of the shielding member **121** and the transmission member **122** illustrated in FIG. 2 are not limited thereto. The shapes of the shielding member **121** and the transmission member **122** according to another embodiment of the present disclosure may be a curved structure or a banding structure.

[0047] The light leakage prevention member **120** may be disposed in a local area where masking painting is not possible.

[0048] The transmission member **122** may be disposed in front of any one of the plurality of light sources **151** and **152** formed on the PCB **150**. The transmission member **122** is formed based on a transparent material so as to emit light by using light of a light source disposed at the rear.

[0049] A partial region of the transmission member **122** may be exposed to the outside direction of the cover unit **110**. For example, the transmission member **122** may transmit visual information to the user by using light emitted from the second light source **152**.

[0050] The transmission member **122** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure has a polar molecular structure. The transmission member **122** may be manufactured based on, for example, one of polycarbonate (PC), polymethyl methacrylate (PMMA), and polyamide (PA).

[0051] On the other hand, the shielding member **121** has a nonpolar molecular structure. The shielding member **121** may be manufactured based on, for example, one of polyethylene (PE) and polypropylene (PP).

[0052] When the light leakage prevention member **120** is manufactured based on the double injection molding, the transmission member **122** and the shielding member **121** are separated from each other. The fact that the transmission member **122** and the shielding member **121** are separated from each other means that a microspace is formed between the transmission member **122** and the shielding members **121**. Although the transmission member **122** and the shielding member **121** are manufactured based on a double injection molding, they may be separated due to different polarities.

[0053] The molecular structure between the transmission member **122** and the shielding member **121** may be separated by a van der Waals force. Here, the van der Waals force means an attractive force or repulsion between molecules or between parts in one molecule, and not a covalent bond or an electrical interaction of ions. Specifically, in the case of a nonpolar molecule, a dipole molecule is formed due to the motion of electrons, and a molecule next to the dipole molecule also undergoes temporary polarization to generate an induced dipole. This instantaneous attractive force between the dipole molecule and the induced dipole is called the van der Waals force.

[0054] Van der Waals forces include the Keesom force, the permanent induced dipole (Debye) force and the London dispersion force.

[0055] The Keesom force refers to the bond between permanent dipoles, which is the bond between polar and polar. The permanent induced dipole force means a bond between a permanent dipole and an induced dipole that is a bond between polar and nonpolar. The London dispersion force refers to the coupling between the induced dipole and the induced dipole, which is the coupling between the nonpolar and the nonpolar. The binding force is strong in the order of Keesom force, permanent induced dipole force and London dispersion force. Compared with polar and polar materials, polar and nonpolar materials have relatively weak bonding strength. Therefore, in the light leakage prevention member **120** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure, the shielding

member **121** and the transmission member **122** may be separated from each other based on a permanent induced dipole force of polar and nonpolar materials.

[0056] In the case where a microspace is formed between the transmission member **122** and the shielding member **121**, light transmitted through the transmission member **122** may be reflected without being absorbed when irradiated to the side of the shielding member **122**. Therefore, the light leakage prevention member **120** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure may be disposed in an area requiring a high brightness specification.

[0057] The housing **130** is disposed on an upper end of the rubber pad **140**. The housing **130** is coupled to the rubber pad **140** in accordance with a position of a hole (not shown) formed on the rubber pad **140**. The hole formed on the rubber pad **140** may be formed based on the positions of the first light source **151** and the second light source **152**.

[0058] The housing **130** includes a receiving space for receiving the light leakage prevention member **120**. The receiving space includes a groove to which the light leakage prevention member **120** is coupled. The light leakage prevention member **120** may be restrained from moving in all directions by being coupled to the groove.

[0059] The PCB **150** includes the first light source **151** and the second light source **152**. The first light source **151** and the second light source **152** may be light emitting diodes (LEDs). The first light source **151** and the second light source **152** may be disposed on either top surface of the PCB **150**.

[0060] FIG. **3** is a cross-sectional view taken along line A-A in FIG. **1**.

[0061] Referring to FIG. **3**, the light leakage prevention member **120** may be disposed in front of the second light source **152**. When the first light source **151** emits light, the light emitted from the first light source **151** may be reflected by the inner wall of the housing **130** and the shielding member **121** and may be emitted to the side of the cover unit **110**. Here, the light emitted from the first light source **151** is not transmitted to the transmission member **122**.

[0062] The light emitted from the second light source **152** may be transmitted through the transmission member **122** and emitted to the side of the cover unit **110**. Due to the microspace between the shielding member **121** and the transmission member **122**, the brightness of the light emitted from the second light source **152** may be maintained when the light is transmitted through the transmission member **122**.

[0063] The light leakage prevention member **120** may shield interference between the first light source **151** and the second light source **152**.

[0064] In a light leakage prevention member according to the conventional art, a coupling surface is formed between the shielding member and the transmission member due to the double injection molding. The coupling surface between the black-colored shielding member and the transparent material transmission member has a black color based on the color of the shielding member.

Therefore, the light transmitted through the transmission member may be partially absorbed by the coupling surface having a black color. Therefore, the light leakage prevention member according to the conventional art is not suitable for the high brightness specification, while in the light leakage prevention member **120** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure, the shielding member **121** and the transmission member **122** are separated so that the transmission member **122** does not have a black color unlike the color of the shielding member **122**. Therefore, when the light emitted from the second light source **152** is transmitted through the transmission member **122**, the light is reflected by a microspace **300**, and the brightness may be maintained. Therefore, the light leakage prevention member **120** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure may be disposed in a region where a high brightness specification is required.

[0065] FIG. **4** is a diagram briefly illustrating a configuration of a light leakage prevention apparatus for a vehicle according to another embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0066] Referring to FIG. **4**, a light leakage prevention apparatus for a vehicle **400** according to another embodiment of the present disclosure may include a plurality of shielding members **401**,

402, 403, and 404 and a plurality of transmission members **410, 411, and 412**. The plurality of shielding members **401, 402, 403, and 404** and the plurality of transmission members **410, 411, and 412** may be continuously injected and manufactured.

[0067] The plurality of shielding members **401, 402, 403, and 404** and the plurality of transmission members **410, 411, and 412** may have a curved structure or a banding structure. The structures of the plurality of shielding members **401, 402, 403, and 404** and the plurality of transmission members **410, 411, and 412** are not limited thereto. The plurality of shielding members **401, 402, 403, and 404** and the plurality of transmission members **410, 411, and 412** may be disposed in a curved region to shield interference between the plurality of light sources.

[0068] The plurality of shielding members **401, 402, 403, and 404** and the plurality of transmission members **410, 411, and 412** may be directly coupled onto a PCB **420**. Although not shown in FIG. **4**, the plurality of shielding members **401, 402, 403, and 404** and the plurality of transmission members **410, 411, and 412** may be restrained from moving by an additional structure or the like in the vicinity of the disposed region.

[0069] A light leakage prevention apparatus for a vehicle **400** according to another embodiment of the present disclosure may shield interference between a plurality of light sources **421, 422, and 423**. The light leakage prevention apparatus for a vehicle **400** may shield optical interference between the first light source **421**, the second light source **422**, and the third light source **423**.

[0070] The light leakage prevention apparatus for a vehicle **400** according to another embodiment of the present disclosure includes a shielding member **401**, a second shielding member **402**, a third shielding member **403**, a fourth shielding member **404**, a first transmission member **410**, a second transmission member **411**, and a third transmission member **412**.

[0071] A PCB **420** according to another embodiment of the present disclosure includes some or all of the first light source **421**, the second light source **422**, and the third light source **423**. This is but one embodiment, and the number of light sources included on the PCB **420** may be greater.

[0072] The first transmission member **410** has a polar molecular structure, and the first shielding member **401** and the second shielding member **402** have a nonpolar molecular structure. Therefore, the first transmission member **410** may form microspaces separated from the first shielding member **401** and the second shielding member **402**, respectively. The light emitted from the first light source **421** may be transmitted through the first transmission member **410** and emitted in an outside direction. When the light of the first light source **421** is irradiated to the outside, the path of the light is reflected to the microspace respectively formed between the first transmission member **410** and the first shielding member **401** and the second shielding member **402**. Here, the light emitted from the first light source **421** is reflected without being absorbed into the microspace. Therefore, the brightness of light may be uniformly maintained.

[0073] The second transmission member **411** has a polar molecular structure, and the third shielding member **403** has a nonpolar molecular structure. Therefore, the second transmission member **411** may form microspaces separated from the second shielding member **402** and the third shielding member **403**, respectively. The light emitted from the second light source **422** may be transmitted through the second transmission member **411** and emitted in an outside direction. When the light of the second light source **422** is irradiated to the outside, the path of the light is reflected to the microspaces respectively formed between the second transmission member **411** and the second shielding member **402** and the third shielding member **403**. Here, the light emitted from the second light source **422** is reflected without being absorbed into the microspace. Therefore, the brightness of light may be uniformly maintained.

[0074] The third transmission member **412** has a polar molecular structure, and the fourth shielding member **404** has a nonpolar molecular structure. Therefore, the third transmission member **412** may form microspaces separated from the third shielding member **403** and the fourth shielding member **404**, respectively. The light emitted from the third light source **423** may be transmitted through the third transmission member **412** and emitted in an outside direction. When the light of

the third light source **423** is irradiated to the outside, the path of the light is reflected to the microspace respectively formed between the third transmission member **412** and the third shielding member **403** and the fourth shielding member **404**. Here, the light emitted from the third light source **423** is reflected without being absorbed into the microspace. Therefore, the brightness of light may be uniformly maintained.

[0075] The foregoing descriptions are merely illustrative of the technical concept of the present embodiment, and various modifications and variations may be made by those skilled in the art without departing from the essential characteristics of the present embodiment. Therefore, the present embodiments are not intended to limit the technical concept of the present embodiments, but are intended to be illustrative, and the scope of the technical concept of the present embodiment is not limited by these embodiments. The protection scope of the present embodiment is to be construed according to the following claims, and all technical concepts within the scope equivalent thereto are construed as being included in the scope of rights of the present embodiment.

Claims

1. A light leakage prevention apparatus for a vehicle, the apparatus comprising: a printed circuit board (PCB) comprising two or more light sources; a light leakage prevention member that shields interference between the two or more light sources; a housing including a space for accommodating the light leakage prevention member; and a cover coupled to an upper end of the housing, wherein the light leakage prevention member comprises a transmission member and a shielding member alternately disposed in a direction of light transmission of the two or more light source, and wherein the transmission member and the shielding member are manufactured by a double injection molding such that the transmission member and the shielding member have different color or comprise different materials from each other.
2. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the transmission member is disposed in front of one of the two or more light sources and configured to transmit and emit light of the light source that is disposed at a rear of at least one of the two or more light sources, and wherein the shielding member is coupled to the transmission member and configured to shield light from the light source disposed behind the transmission member and a remainder of the two or more light sources.
3. The apparatus of claim 2, wherein the transmission member and the shielding member have different polarities such that the transmission member and the shielding member form one or more microspaces on surfaces bonded to each other during the double injection molding.
4. The apparatus of claim 3, wherein the transmission member reflects the light of the light source disposed at the rear of the at least one of the two or more light sources to a reflection surface formed from the one or more microspaces.
5. The apparatus of claim 2, wherein the transmission member comprises a polar molecule selected from the group consisting of polycarbonate (PC), polymethyl methacrylate (PMMA), and polyamide (PA).
6. The apparatus of claim 2, wherein the shielding member comprises a nonpolar molecule selected from the group consisting of polyethylene (PE), and polyamide (PP).
7. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the light leakage prevention member is heat treated after the double injection molding.
8. A method for manufacturing a light leakage prevention apparatus for a vehicle, the method comprising: double injection molding a product to form a light leakage prevention member comprising a transmission member and a shielding member alternately disposed in a direction of light transmission of two or more light source in a printed circuit board (PCB); heat-treating the light leakage prevention member; coupling the light leakage prevention member into a receiving space of a housing; and coupling a cover to an upper end of the housing, wherein the transmission member and the shielding member have different color or comprise different materials from each

other by the double injection molding.

9. The method of claim 8, wherein the heat-treating of the light leakage prevention member comprises separating the transmission member and the shielding member from each other by a microspace.

10. The method of claim 8, wherein the coupling of the light leakage prevention member into the receiving space of the housing comprises disposing the light leakage prevention member in front of the at least one of two or more light sources to shield optical interference between different light sources.

11. The method of claim 9, wherein the transmission member comprises a polar molecule selected from the group consisting of polycarbonate (PC), polymethyl methacrylate (PMMA), and polyamide (PA).

12. The method of claim 9, wherein the shielding member comprises a nonpolar molecule selected from the group consisting of polyethylene (PE) and polyamide (PP).
